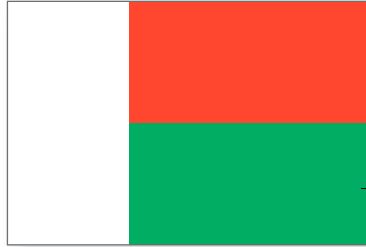


Madagascar

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** October 14, 1958 **Usage:** National and Civil

Red and white were the colors of the Kingdom of Madagascar



Green represents the Hova, the former peasant class

Africa



Madagascar was annexed by France in 1895 and the monarchy abolished two years later. It achieved independence in 1960.

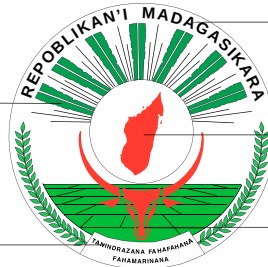
The flag was introduced when self-government was achieved in 1958 and was retained on independence. The red and white are said to symbolize the earlier Merina Kingdom, whose flags were all red and white, with the addition of green for the Hova, the former peasant class. The coat of arms has

changed several times since independence. That of the present republic, introduced in March 1993, shows a map of the island with a spray of leaves. Beneath these is a paddy field surmounted by the head of a zebu. The motto reads "Fatherland, Liberty, Justice." Above the design is the country's name.

ARMS OF MADAGASCAR

The leaves of the traveller's tree

*The national motto—
"Fatherland, Liberty,
Justice"*



The state title is in Malagasy, the local language

An outline of Madagascar

A stylized paddy field and a zebu, a local ox